ELIAS KOCH

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EDUCATION

Hertie School (Research Training Group DYNAMICS) *since Sep 2024*
Doctoral Candidate (Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Simon Munzert & Prof. Dr. Heike Klüver) *Berlin, Germany*

University of Oxford (Nuffield College/DPIR) *scheduled Jan – Mar 2027*
Junior Visiting Scholar *Oxford, United Kingdom*

Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin *Apr 2022 – Aug 2024*
Social Sciences (M.A.), *GPA: 1.0 (Thesis: 1.0)* *Berlin, Germany*

King's College London Sep 2023 – Jan 2024
Studies Abroad (European Studies, M.A.) *London, United Kingdom*

Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin Oct 2018 - Sep 2022
Social Sciences (B.A.), *GPA: 1.6 (Thesis: 1.0)* *Berlin, Germany*

ACADEMIC WORK EXPERIENCE

Hertie School (Prof. Dr. Simon Munzert) since Sep 2024
Research Associate *Berlin, Germany*

- Research on attitudinal & behavioural consequences of election polling among political elites & voters.
- Associated with the DFG-funded Research Project "Election Forecasts for the German Federal Election 2025" in cooperation with Prof. Dr. Thomas Gschwend and Prof. Dr. Lukas Stötzer.

Research Training Group DYNAMICS since Sep 2024
Associated Research Fellow *Berlin, Germany*

Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin (Prof. Dr. Heike Klüver) May 2023 - Aug 2024
Student Research Assistant at the Chair of *Comparative Political Behavior* *Berlin, Germany*

University of Greifswald (Prof. Dr. Jochen Müller) Nov 2022 - Jun 2024
Student Research Assistant at the Chair of *Political Sociology & Methods* *Greifswald, Germany*

Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin (Prof. Dr. Jochen Müller/Prof. Dr. Andreas Schäfer) May 2021 - May 2023
Student Research Assistant at the Chair of *German Politics* *Berlin, Germany*

Alexander von Humboldt-Institute for Internet & Society (Dr. Benedikt Fecher) Oct 2019 - May 2021
Student Research Assistant at the Research Unit *Knowledge & Society* *Berlin, Germany*

FURTHER TRAINING

Oxford Large Language Models for Social Science Workshop	2026
Design and analysis of experiments (Macartan Humphreys)	2026
ECPR Summer School on Parliaments	2024
Circle-U Summer School at the University of Oslo: Evidence & Democracy	2023
Programming Methods for Data Retrieval and Management (C. Gandrud)	2022

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Internship at the Institute for Parliamentary Research (Dr. Benjamin Höhne)	Aug - Sep 2021
Internship at the Heinrich-Böll Foundation (Dr. Sebastian Bukow, Policy & Party Research)	Feb - Apr 2020
Internship at the German Association for eMobility (BEM)	Jul - Sep 2018
Parliamentary Assistant at the German Bundestag	Sep 2018 - Jun 2019
Internship at the German Bundestag	Jan - Jun 2018

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Koch, Elias (2026). *Opposition parties seek more conflict with the government when losing electoral support.* West European Politics. 49(5), 1336–1354. DOI: 10.1080/01402382.2025.2524944
→ Featured by the ECPR *The Loop* Blog

Koch, Elias & Andreas Küpfer (2025). *The Politics of Seeking and Avoiding Discourse in Parliament.* European Journal of Political Research (EJPR). 64(4): 1899-1922. DOI: 10.1111/1475-6765.70013.
→ Featured by the LSE European Public Policy Blog

Erfort, Cornelius, Lukas F. Stoetzer, Thomas Gschwend, Hannah Rajski, Simon Munzert & **Elias Koch** (2025). *An election forecasting model for subnational elections.* Electoral Studies. 95, DOI: 10.1016/j.electstud.2025.102939.

Erfort, Cornelius, Lukas F. Stoetzer, Thomas Gschwend, **Elias Koch**, Simon Munzert & Hannah Rajski (2025). *The Zweitstimme Forecast for the German Federal Election 2025: Coalition Majorities and Vacant Districts. PS: Politics and Political Science* (PS), 59(1): 48-54. DOI: 10.1017/S1049096525000150.
→ Best Paper Award 2025; APSA Political Forecasting Group

Koch, Elias, Daniel Kuhlen, Jochen Müller & Christian Stecker (2024). *StatePol — A Database on the Members of Governments and Parliaments in the 16 German States.* German Political Science Quarterly (PVS). 65, p 759–783. DOI: 10.1007/s11615-024-00528-z.
→ Discussed by Steffen Mau (2024; Chapter 1)

Other Publications

Höhne, Benjamin & **Elias Koch** (2023). *Wie weiter mit der Parteiorganisation nach Merkel? Eine Analyse der Debatten auf Regionalkonferenzen zum neuen Parteivorsitz.* Zeitschrift für Parteienwissenschaften. 29(3) DOI: 10.24338/mip-2023313-342.

Bukow, Sebastian & **Elias Koch** (2021). *Erfolgreiches Scheitern: Bündnis 90/Die Grünen und die Bundestagswahl 2017.* In Ursula Münch, Heinrich Oberreuter & Jörg Siegmund (Eds.), *Komplexe Farbenlehre: Perspektiven des deutschen Parteiensystems im Kontext der Bundestagswahl 2017* (S. 227–249). Campus. [Link]

WORK IN PROGRESS

Under Review

- *Going off-topic: How parties re-frame political debates* (with Christoph Ivanusch)
- *Visual presentation raises trust in election polls* (Lead-authored work with Simon Munzert, Linus Hagemann, Cornelius Erfort, Thomas Gschwend, Hannah Rajski & Lukas F. Stoetzer), DOI: 10.31235/osf.io/a3q2y_v1

Working Papers

- *When Democracy is at Stake: Polity-seeking in Party Competition* (Single-Authored)
- *Voter coordination in proportional elections* (Lead-authored work with Lukas F. Stoetzer & Thomas Gschwend)

In Preparation

- *Can an Interactive Dashboard Teach Polling Literacy? Evidence from a Large-Scale Experiment* (with Simon Munzert, Linus Hagemann, Cornelius Erfort, Thomas Gschwend, Hannah Rajski & Lukas F. Stoetzer)
- *The causal effect of electoral information* (with Simon Munzert)

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS (INCL. SCHEDULED)

Conferences

American Political Science Association (APSA) 2026
European Political Science Society (EPSS) 2026
European Political Science Association (EPSA) 2025
European Graduate Network Conference (EGN) 2026
German Political Science Association (DVPW)
- Standing Group on *Elections & Public Opinion* 2025
- Standing Group on *Comparative Legislative Studies* 2023
- Standing Group on *Governance in the Federal Republic of Germany* 2023
- Standing Group on *Analytical Political Theory* 2024, 2025, 2026

Danish Political Science Association (DPSA) 2026
International Association for the Study of German Politics (IASGP) 2023, 2024, 2025

Workshops

Contesting Democracy: Citizens, Parties, and the Politics of Erosion in Europe (University of Zurich) 2027
Workshop on Compromise and Concession from a Voter Perspective (AAU Copenhagen) 2026
Mannheim Opposition Workshop (MZES) 2026
Zweitstimme Workshop on Elections, Public Opinion and Elite Behaviour (Hertie School) 2025
Junior Scholar Workshop - Transformations of Democracy (WZB) 2025, 2026

SCHOLARSHIPS & GRANTS

IASGP: Research Funding (with Markus Kollberg, £3,000) 2026
Humboldt-Universität Berlin, Department of Social Science: Event Participation Grant (834€) 2024
German Academic Scholarship Foundation (Studienstiftung des dt. Volkes): Study Grant 2023-2024
German Academic Scholarship Foundation (Studienstiftung des dt. Volkes): Grant for studies in the UK 2023
DAAD PROMOS Scholarship UK (declined) 2023

INVITED TALKS

2026 University of Mainz
2025 Mannheim Centre for European Social Research, Technical University of Darmstadt
2024 University of Potsdam, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin
2023 University of Greifswald

TEACHING

Political Parties and Public Opinion (M.A. seminar; University of Greifswald) *Winter 2026/27*
This seminar examines how political parties navigate dynamic public opinion environments in modern democracies. After an introduction to the strategic goals of competitive parties, the first part of the seminar covers how parties react to shifting polls, rising issue salience, and shifting voter attitudes. The second part explores how parties influence voters' perceptions and preferences through communication, policy positioning, and adopting other parties' strategies.

SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

Reviewer Activities European Journal of Political Research, Electoral Studies, Journal of Contemporary European Studies, Journal of Politics, Party Politics, Swiss Political Science Review
Advisory Activities Bertelsmann Foundation (Advisory Board of the *Demokratiemonitor*)
Hosted Events Zweitstimme Workshop on Elections, Public Opinion & Elite Behaviour (2025)
Fieldwork Supported collection of the 2nd wave of the European Panel of Local Officials
Supported collection of the 2025 *Zweitstimme* voter-, candidate-, and journalist survey
Selection Committees German Academic Scholarship Foundation (Studienstiftung; 2025, 2026)
Hertie School DocGov PhD Program (2025)

SKILLS

Software	RStudio, Qualtrics, LaTeX, Stata, MaxQDA
Methods	Regression Analysis, Causal Inference, Experimental Methods, Data Visualisation, Text Analysis Geospatial Data Analysis, Webscraping
Languages	German & Swedish (Mother Tongues), English (C2), French (basic understanding)

Last update: October 2026